30. Which one of the following is the most appropriate definition of a desert?
    (a) A region where the rate of evaporation is higher to that rate of precipitation.
    (b) A region characterized by sand dunes.
    (c) A region devoid of forests and vegetation.
    (d) A region where the average annual rainfall is less than 20 cm.
31. Which one of the following statements is not correct about the cold desert fauna and flora?
    (a) Cold deserts have alpine mesophytes vegetation.
    (b) Birch, juniper and rhododendron and grasses are the main vegetation.
    (c) Some flora grow in the permanently frozen soil.
    (d) Animals and birds have usually long legs.
32. Consider the following statements and select the correct answer using the code given below:
    1. The sacred groves have been threatened because of the disappearance of traditional belief system.
    2. The traditional beliefs and rituals are considered as mere superstition.
    3. Encroachment has led to shrinkage of sacred groves.

    Codes:
    (a) 1 and 2 are correct
    (b) 1 and 3 are correct
    (c) 2 and 3 are correct
    (d) 1, 2 and 3 are correct
33. Which of the following statements is/are correct?
    1. The National Biosphere Reserves Programme in India was initiated in 1986.
    2. One of the objectives of the Biosphere Progaramme in India was to ensure participation of local inhabitants for effective management of the Biosphere Reserves.
    3. To integrate scientific research with traditional knowledge of conservation.
    4. To promote eco-tourism.

    Select the correct answer using the code given below:
    (a) 1, 2 and 3 only